THREADS OF TRADITION

Elevating India's Handicraft Heritage through Geographical Indications

A Geographical Indication (GI) is a label or sign used on products that have a specific geographical origin and possess unique qualities, characteristics, or a reputation inherently linked to that origin. The concept of GI extends beyond a mere trademark or brand name; it serves as a **certification** indicating that a product possesses certain qualities or enjoys a certain reputation due to its geographical origin. This origin can be a town, a region, or a country. The essence of a GI tag lies in the connection between the specific geographical region and the product itself, where the qualities, characteristics, or reputation of the product are essentially attributable to its place of origin.



India's vast cultural and artisanal diversity is mirrored in its robust portfolio of Geographical Indications (GIs). The government, under the visionary guidance of **Hon'ble Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi** and led by **Piyush Goyal, Hon'ble Union Minister of Commerce and Industry, Consumer Affairs, Food and Public Distribution, Textiles**, has been steadfast in its efforts to promote and safeguard GI tagged products. This commitment has significantly contributed to economic growth, cultural preservation, and elevating India's distinct products on a global stage, thanks to the strategic initiatives and persistent dedication of the **Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT)**.

GI TAGS: Empowering Artisans, Enriching Culture and Indian Handicraft Heritage

The implementation of Geographical Indication (GI) tags in India's handloom sector has had a **significant impact** on the economic well-being of artisans and weavers. By recognizing and protecting the unique products of different regions, GI tags have helped in creating a niche market, where the authenticity of these products commands a **premium price**. This has been particularly transformative for small-scale artisans and local communities who rely on traditional handloom techniques. GI tags have opened up **new market opportunities**, both domestically and internationally, leading to **increased incomes** and financial stability for these artisans. The recognition that comes with a GI tag adds **significant value** to the products. Consumers, increasingly aware of the **uniqueness and quality guaranteed by GI tags**, are willing to pay higher prices, directly benefiting the producers. This has led to a renewed interest in traditional crafts, providing a much-needed financial boost to artisans who were otherwise struggling to compete with mass-produced goods. The increased demand for GI-tagged products has also led to the **creation of more job opportunities** in rural and underdeveloped areas, further contributing to the economic development of these regions.